Calm-Down Skills Practice

Practice one or more grounding and breathing skills you can use when anxiety starts to rise.

Name: _____	**Date:** _____
Counselor: _____	**Session:** _____

A. Slow Breathing Practice

Try this for 1-3 minutes. Breathe gently; do not force a deep breath.

Step	What to do
1	Sit or stand in a comfortable position.
2	Breathe in slowly through your nose for about 4 counts.
3	Pause briefly if comfortable.
4	Breathe out slowly for about 6 counts.
5	Repeat and keep your shoulders relaxed.

Before breathing: anxiety ___ /10 **After breathing:** anxiety ___ /10

B. 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding

Look around and gently bring your attention to the present moment.

5 things I can SEE

4 things I can FEEL or TOUCH

3 things I can HEAR

2 things I can SMELL

1 thing I can TASTE or one calming thing I can tell myself

C. Choose a coping statement

Check one or write your own:

[ ] This feeling will pass. [ ] I can handle one step at a time. [ ] I do not have to solve everything right now.

[ ] I can ask for support. [ ] I can focus on what I can control.

My own calming statement:

D. My personal reset plan

When I notice anxiety rising, the first skill I will try is:

If I still feel overwhelmed, I can contact or approach:

Note: If a student is in immediate danger or unable to stay safe, follow the school or institution's emergency and crisis procedures.